



Luke Michaels

Senior UX/UI Designer & Developer

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SUMMARY

User experience-focused designer and front-end developer with 15+ years building intuitive, accessible digital products across complex workflows. Expert in Figma, design systems, and translating intricate requirements into clean, scalable experiences. Deep technical fluency in HTML/CSS and modern JavaScript enables tight, high-quality collaboration with engineering teams. Proven track record driving measurable UX outcomes – improved accessibility scores, reduced bounce rates, and accelerated delivery timelines – through research-informed design, reusable component libraries, and cross-functional partnership.

CORE COMPETENCIES

UX Strategy & Research, Interaction Design & Prototyping, Design Systems & Component Libraries, WCAG Accessibility, Figma, HTML5 / CSS3 / Sass, JavaScript / React / TypeScript, Agile Product Teams, Stakeholder Facilitation Usability Testing, Information Architecture, Cross-Functional Collaboration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Web Developer & UX Designer Mercy For Animals

09/17 to 11/25 | Remote / Portland, OR

Led end-to-end UX and front-end development for a global advocacy platform serving millions of annual visitors. Defined experience strategy, built and governed a reusable design system, and partnered with non-technical stakeholders to translate complex content workflows into intuitive, accessible interfaces.

- Architected a modular component framework adopted by 20+ non-technical staff, reducing developer dependency by 30% and compressing campaign launch timelines from 2 weeks to 3 days – directly enabling faster time-to-market for high-impact programs.
- Owned and evolved the design system and ACF Pro block library (200+ reusable components), establishing contribution standards, governance practices, and adoption plans aligned with engineering implementation.

- Championed WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility across all public-facing properties, achieving 95%+ Lighthouse accessibility scores through semantic HTML, keyboard/focus patterns, ARIA, color contrast, and screen reader validation.
- Drove a 15–20% reduction in bounce rates on key landing pages through evidence-based interaction design – including an advanced mobile slider with GPU-accelerated animation and full assistive technology support.
- Improved Core Web Vitals (LCP, CLS, TTI) by up to 40%, increasing mobile PageSpeed scores from the 60s to 90+ via strategic asset optimization, code-splitting, and caching – demonstrating performance-aware UX thinking.
- Designed and built A/B-test-ready CTA components deployed across multiple international campaigns, standardizing UX patterns and accelerating deployment speed by 50%.
- Facilitated design reviews and stakeholder feedback loops with product, content, and leadership teams; documented decisions, tradeoffs, and rationale to maintain alignment across distributed teams.
- Mentored and supported non-technical team members in using the design system effectively, reducing reliance on developer intervention and improving overall design consistency.
- Maintained and refactored legacy codebases, reducing technical debt and cutting new engineer onboarding time by ~25%.

Front-End Developer & UX Designer DHX Advertising

02/16 to 09/17 | Portland, OR

- Translated design mockups into responsive, accessible front-end implementations for regional and national marketing clients, applying UX best practices throughout.

- Built custom WordPress and Drupal solutions – themes, templates, component systems, and animated interactions – emphasizing clean information architecture and mobile-first design.
- Delivered performance-optimized, SEO-friendly sites across desktop and mobile, consistently meeting accessibility and usability standards.

Web Designer & Front-End Developer Needmore Designs

11/15 to 02/16 | Portland, OR

- Designed and built elegant, design-forward websites for artisan and boutique brands, with a focus on custom CMS experiences accessible to non-technical clients.
- Created responsive, accessible interfaces with refined CSS animations and intuitive content management patterns.

Web Designer & Developer Conscious Box

10/13 to 11/15 | Portland, OR

- Designed marketing pages, subscription onboarding flows, and email campaigns, balancing business conversion goals with clean, user-friendly experiences.
- Implemented A/B tested landing pages that meaningfully improved conversion rates and user engagement metrics.
- Managed brand visual consistency across web, print, email, and social channels.

Web Designer & Developer Bob's Red Mill Natural Foods

04/11 to 10/13 | Milwaukie, OR

- Improved site UX, navigation, and checkout flows across Magento and WooCommerce platforms to reduce friction and enhance customer experience.
- Designed promotional graphics, product pages, and merchandising assets; assisted with SEO and site performance improvements.

Earlier Roles (2005–2011):

Web design and front-end development across agencies and studios – Off The Wall Media, Print Time, LineDrive, Title Boxing, and others – producing UX-focused

web experiences, interactive features, and brand assets.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Personal Portfolio & Dashboard | React, Next.js, Framer Motion

Component-based portfolio built with React and Next.js, demonstrating modern front-end architecture, complex state management, and responsive animation – achieving a 100/100 Lighthouse performance score.

Nutty Narrows Thrift Shop | React, TypeScript, Redux, API Integration

Designed and architected an accessible, immersive informational site using React and TypeScript, with custom animations, smooth page transitions, and global UI state managed via Redux.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

UX & Design: User research, wireframing, high-fidelity prototyping, interaction design, information architecture, usability testing, journey mapping

Design Tools: Figma, Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects, InDesign, Blender

Design Systems: Component library governance, contribution standards, adoption planning, style guides, pattern libraries

Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA, semantic HTML5, keyboard/focus patterns, ARIA, screen reader testing, color contrast, responsive behavior

Front-End: HTML5, CSS3/Sass, JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, React, Vue, Tailwind, Bootstrap, Webpack, Vite

CMS / Platforms: WordPress (custom themes, ACF Pro blocks, Gutenberg), Drupal, Magento, WooCommerce

Other: Git/GitHub, Node.js, PHP, MySQL, Google Cloud, AWS, Cloudflare, performance optimization, Core Web Vitals

EDUCATION

A.S. in Computer Science & Digital Media
Full Sail University | Orlando, FL

